

The Public Sentiment Institute Methodology Statement

Data Collection

TPSI polls are conducted using a variety of online panels, including Pollfish and CINT.

Respondents on CINT are directed to the site Qualtrics to answer survey questions.

Pollfish surveys are conducted using the organic sampling procedure in which respondents are invited to take surveys through a number of partner apps. Samples are stratified by age and quotas are often used for other demographics when necessary.

Only current registered voters are surveyed in LV and RV polls.

Data Quality

TPSI utilizes a variety of methods to remove fraudulent responses from surveys. Attention check questions are used, with failing participants removed from the sample and we also remove respondents who “straightline” or answer the survey in an unrealistic time. Qualtrics automatically conducts these procedures and we perform them manually when using Pollfish.

Survey Weighting (RV)

Registered voters are weighted to match areas being polled’s demographics after examining the voter file. Surveys are weighted for age, sex, race, education, recalled 2024 vote in general elections, race/education, and vote frequency. These weights are applied using Python.

Survey Weighting (LV)

Prior to fielding, we establish pre-survey benchmarks derived from an analysis of Census data and previous election studies, supplemented by cycle-specific expectations for turnout composition. These benchmarks serve as priors against which survey-observed demographics will be evaluated.

Upon survey completion, each respondent is assigned an individual vote probability score based on their responses to a battery of likely voter screen questions. These probabilities are aggregated across demographic subgroups to construct a projected electorate composition as observed on the survey date. The projected composition is then combined with the pre-survey priors to produce final demographic targets that reflect both empirical survey data and externally grounded expectations for the cycle. Weighting proceeds in two stages. In the first stage, each respondent receives a base weight equal to their individual vote probability to ensure the LV universe is constructed independently, without reference to registered voter weights. In the second stage, a multi-round raking procedure is applied against the final LV-specific demographic targets, calibrating the sample to the projected electorate. A separate recall calibration pass uses verified voter file shares to anchor partisan composition, without a non-voter anchor, as the LV screen has already excluded likely non-voters from the universe.

This process produces a likely voter weight that is fully independent of the registered voter weight track and reflects the double uncertainty inherent in LV estimation: who turns out, and how they are distributed across the electorate.